Preferred Sources: reader opt-in and current Search eligibility

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Strengths and best use

Google's Preferred Sources feature gives an existing reader a direct way to favor a publication in supported Search experiences. The current documentation covers Top Stories and preferred badges in AI Mode and AI Overviews. A clear opt-in link is useful for a publication with returning readers. Google documentation (https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/preferred-sources)

Current checks

The November 7 documentation goes beyond the dossier's older Top Stories-only explanation. Domain and subdomain sites can be eligible, while a subdirectory is not a separate preferred source. Confirm that the publication appears in Google's preference picker and check the documented eligibility for AI Search features. Reader selection and normal search discovery remain separate measurements. Current eligibility and implementation (https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/preferred-sources)

Implement a simple reference link

Replace the example domain with the publication's real domain. Google's documentation also provides an optional localized JavaScript button and custom SDK paths.

```
<a href="https://www.google.com/preferences/source?q=example.com">
  Add as a preferred source
</a>
```

Verify the destination on mobile and desktop, the publication selected, keyboard access, visible focus, and the return path. Measure button use and returning-reader behavior with an appropriate observation window. Keep sitemap, canonical, and indexing checks in the broader launch SEO workflow. SEO fundamentals (https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/seo-starter-guide)

Reusable prompt

```
Check this publication against the current Preferred Sources documentation. Verify its
eligible domain in the picker, implement the documented opt-in route, and test accessibility
and return behavior. Separate observed button use from any unmeasured search-traffic effect.
```

Project idea

Add a publisher opt-in test sheet covering domain eligibility, link behavior, device, locale, and reader-feedback observations.

Original sources

- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DeyBx9-vl0k/